

Dispatch SOP: safe queue triage and proposal workflow

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Authority: Simulated demo guidance. Primary source: *Dark Store Last-Mile Dispatch Playbook* (sample operations document, illustrative thresholds only), sections 2, 3 and 7. Team decisions are recorded in the corpus README. Not a real-world company SOP.

Applies to: Manager questions about current backlog, dispatch priority, staffing levers, and proposed changes.

Purpose and source boundaries

Use this procedure to explain a dispatch problem and prepare manager-reviewable options. The corpus provides rules, not current operational facts. Queue depth, order ages, item flags, rider availability and hours, stage measurements, rain status, and timestamps come from the relevant tool.

Triage sequence

1. **Establish the snapshot.** Read the live tool's as_of time and store identity. State that time when reporting live facts. Do not describe an old snapshot as current.
2. **Describe the queue by state.** Separate packed orders waiting for riders, orders still being picked, and orders already out for delivery. Identify the oldest waiting order and relevant order attributes only from returned records.
3. **Check capacity and safety.** Use tool-returned available/returning/on-break/offline/standby rider states. Verify hours and break status before suggesting an assignment. A rider returning soon is not yet an available rider; a rider on break is not available. Do not count standby capacity as on-site capacity.
4. **Name the bottleneck using evidence.** Use historical stage metrics for pick-pack, rider wait, and ride. If only a live queue snapshot is available, describe the observed queue condition; do not claim that a historical stage metric proves the cause.
5. **Prioritize the oldest eligible work.** Always dispatch the oldest waiting packed order first, subject to safety and policy. Do not delay an order just to create a batch. Apply every batching condition before describing a batch as eligible.
6. **Offer safe capacity and expectation options.** Depending on returned facts and applicable playbook rules, options can include using riders who are available or returning, contacting standby, compliant batching, temporarily reducing serviceability, and an honest customer delay notice. These are proposals, not actions taken.
7. **Check constraints and preferences.** Apply hard safety, hours, break, cold-chain, and order-age rules first. Apply remembered store preferences when stricter. If information is missing or a preference conflicts with a proposed action, identify the issue and ask the manager to resolve it.
8. **Return a concise evidence-led answer.** Lead with what is happening and why, state the supporting facts and their source/time, then list prioritized drafts with constraints and uncertainty.

Draft-only actions and approvals

A rider assignment, order batch, standby call-in, radius change, incentive, or customer/rider message may be prepared as a draft. It is not executed, and success is not reported, unless a distinct manager approval step has occurred in the demo. Every proposed state change is labeled as a proposal/draft

and left for explicit manager approval.

Memory and preference handling

Store preferences can set alert thresholds, windows, stricter batching constraints, incentive caps, and handover notes. Apply them across sessions when retrieved. A preference cannot authorize unsafe work, exceed a policy limit, or make an otherwise ineligible batch eligible. Surface a conflict and leave the decision to the manager; never silently replace either rule or preference.